Elite Workout Manual

Chapter 9 – Progressive Overload & 12-Week Progression

Objective

Provide a structured progression system so strength, muscle, pull-up ability, and athletic performance improve consistently over 12 weeks.

Concept	Rule
RIR	Finish most sets with 1–2 reps in reserve.
Double Progression	Reach top of rep range before increasing weight.
Load Increase	Upper body: +2–2.5 kg. Lower body: +2.5–5 kg when targets are met.
Technique	Never increase load if form breaks down.
Failure	Avoid failure except occasional final isolation set.

Double Progression Example

Example: Bench Press 4×5–8. Stay at the same weight until all four sets reach 8 reps with 1–2 RIR. Then increase the load at the next session and return to 5–6 reps.

Weeks	Primary Focus
1–2	Learn technique, establish baseline loads.
3–4	Increase reps where possible.
5–6	Increase loads on exercises meeting progression criteria.
7	Evaluate fatigue. Deload if recovery indicators decline.
8–10	Resume progression with slightly heavier loads.
11–12	Push for best performance while maintaining form.

If You Miss Workouts

Miss 1 workout: continue normally. Miss 2–3 consecutive workouts: repeat the previous week's loads. Miss more than one week: reduce loads by about 10% and rebuild.

Breaking Plateaus

First check sleep, protein, hydration, and technique. Only change the program after these factors are addressed. Most plateaus are caused by recovery or inconsistent training rather than poor exercise selection.

Coach's Rule

Your biggest limiter has been consistency. The goal is to complete every scheduled session before worrying about maximizing weight increases. Consistent progression beats aggressive progression.